STUDENT SERVICES / UC-STU-05

Resource Waiting Lists & Automatic Assignment

An eligible student joins a waiting list for an unavailable room or equipment; the responsible staff member reviews it, and an approved request may be fulfilled automatically when a compatible resource becomes available.

Primary actor	Authenticated student requester
Supporting actors	Room-owning faculty administrator or equipment custodian; allocation service; notification service
Preconditions	The student is eligible for the resource; existing room/equipment workflows and responsible staff assignments are configured.

Main success scenario

1. Student requests a room or equipment for exact requirements and dates. If no compatible option is available, the system offers alternatives and an option to join the waiting list.
2. Student opens the waiting-list policy, explicitly accepts automatic assignment and notification terms; the system records the accepted policy version and timestamp.
3. The system adds one active waiting entry linked to the original request, shows review status and an estimated queue position; the student may cancel freely while waiting.
4. The authorized faculty administrator or equipment custodian sees relevant applicant/request details and may pre-approve or reject even while all compatible resources are unavailable.
5. For pre-approved entries, the system displays the eligible position and updates it when requests cancel, are rejected, become ineligible or are fulfilled.
6. When compatible availability arises, the system fairly selects an eligible pre-approved entry, rechecks dates, policy, faculty authorization and conflicts, and atomically confirms the room or reserves equipment for collection.
7. The student receives an in-app confirmation. Equipment collection still requires a custodian-verified physical handover; request/queue history is retained.

Business rules and constraints

Queue ordering	First-come-first-served among equally eligible/priority requests competing for compatible resources; positions are contextual, may change, and do not guarantee fulfillment.
Approvals and safety	Pre-approval does not hold resources. Never overbook, substitute a different time, bypass owning-faculty approval or treat overdue equipment as returned.
Notifications	Notify on join, review decision, first entering top three, reaching #1, final assignment or cancellation; avoid repeated notices for minor changes.
Automatic assignment	Accepted consent replaces a second student-acceptance step. Enforce adequate advance notice, final authorization and transactional checks; never penalize last-minute allocations.
Privacy and conduct	Only authorized staff see applicant/request details. Students see only their own queue information; verified no-shows and proportionate restrictions require a separately approved policy.

Alternative outcomes

No suitable resource: remain waiting or accept an alternative. Staff rejection, withdrawal or ineligibility: close the active queue entry. Lost race / late availability: do not overbook; continue waiting and explain the outcome. Missing responsible approver: block auto-confirmation.

Postconditions

Fulfilled: compatible room reserved or equipment held for verified collection, with a notification and audit trail. Still waiting: no active reservation. Rejected/cancelled: queue position is released and affected positions are updated.